What databases and SQL are. A relational database stores data in tables made of rows and columns. Each row is one record and each column holds one kind of value. A primary key identifies each row, and a foreign key points at a row in another table. SQL is the language used to work with these tables.

Querying with SELECT. The SELECT statement retrieves data from one table. Write SELECT, the columns, FROM and the table name. Rename columns with AS and remove duplicates with SELECT DISTINCT. Filtering with WHERE keeps only the rows that match a condition, using comparison and logical operators.

Joining tables. Joins combine rows from related tables. An inner join keeps rows that match in both tables, and a left join keeps every row from the left table. Keys link tables together: the foreign key in one table matches the primary key in the other.